

For ethical hackers in the business sector, this usually entails safeguarding company assets; for those working for the government, it often entails preserving national security by safeguarding systems and secrets from terrorists.

Hacker Classifications (White Hat, Black Hat, Gray Hat)

Despite the “hat” motif, hackers are not easily identified by their headwear.

Here’s a breakdown of the many categories of hackers, starting with white hats and black hats:

The Six Types of Hackers



White-Hat Hacker

A white-hat hacker is a cybersecurity expert hired to identify vulnerabilities in software, hardware, and networks that could be exploited, report on those flaws, and help secure those weak points.

They will reveal vulnerabilities to the vendor whose hardware or software is affected, according to TechTarget.com, so that it can repair other customers’ systems.

Many of the same methodologies, tools, and strategies are used by white-hat hackers as they are by black-hat hackers.

Black-hat hacker

The outlaws are the black-hat hackers.

They’re notorious for hacking into victims’ networks unlawfully in order to disrupt systems, steal or destroy data, conduct espionage, or occasionally just to prove they can.

Black-hat hackers are often well-versed in bypassing security procedures and breaking into computer networks.

Some are also skilled at creating malware that is used to infect computers.

Gray-Hat Hacker

Grey-hat hackers incorporate elements of both white- and black-hat hackers,